

“Take-Off” by Ria Shroff

“Flight 89B will begin boarding in 5 minutes.”

The intercom chimes,
Leaving a lingering feeling behind
That the 4 hour wait time
now runs in just its single lines.

The glass panes in front of me
Protect me from the stormy blues
But remind me of the past
That I leave behind, as if I’m bruised

Memories of the past
Flood through my brain
Like an old film reel
Made of wax, bloodstained

Farewell presses hard on my heart
Like a freight train running over a car

Concealing, I look up to the sky
But all I seem to find
Is a white, vast dome
With little brown birds inside

Reminding me of the dreams I'm meant to chase
I once again look at the glass panes
And see the planes take off to the clear sky
Making me realize that all I have to do is try.